The Judgement

Purpose: *The Judgement is to vindicate the Character of God.*

Centred on: *In the Judgement, God is really on trial and not just us.*

The fact God is on trial presents a totally different paradigm on the judgement scene. When most people think of the judgement, it is often self-centred. This **is not** what the Bible portrays. We will discover that the Bible presents the judgement scene in a radically new perspective… with God on trial. The writers of the Bible welcomed the Judgement with open arms, it was something they prayed and hoped for. The judgement is good news.

Part one:

Hebrews 9: 27… Nobody can escape the Judgement its something that death itself can't escape!

Why there has to be a Judgement;

Romans 3: 23… All have sinned.

John 3: 16… All have been given the invitation for salvation.

Hebrews 10: 38-39… According to this text, it is possible to forfeit your salvation.

2 Peter 2: 20-22… Again an example of turning ones back on salvation. This is important because it shows us that God treasures freedom of choice. Both before & after coming to Jesus.

The word Judgement simply means "to examine into, to reach a verdict". If God removed the freedom the choice from everybody, there would be no need for a judgement. The purpose of the Judgement is to finalise the decisions that people are making. Before Jesus comes there will be a finalising of these decisions.

Daniel 7: 10… Note the reference to books.

Revelation 20: 12… Again a reference to books being used to record actions/deeds perhaps?

Psalm 139: 1-4… The OT testifies that God knows everything.

Matthew 10: 30… It would be pretty hard to pull a swiftie over God.

Critical thinking point:
So why does there need to be a judgement if God is omniscient? Remember, Judgement is a process of evaluation of all relevant data in order to reach a verdict. So if God already knows everything, why does he need to engage himself into examination of people's lives in order to reach a verdict?

If God knows everything, that means the investigation and the process of judgement is not to inform him of something he did not already know. The whole investigation process is not to benefit **Him** with new knowledge; it is rather for **our** benefit. He investigates before he takes action to inspire confidence with everyone else.

Now, in order for us to better understand the Judgment in the end, we need to understand Gods judgement in the beginning.

Pattern of Gods Judgement;

Genesis 3: 8-11… Here God is seen to be asking Questions. None of which he did not already know the answer to. The questions were not to benefit **Himself** but rather for the benefit of Adam and Eve. **God wishes that Adam was fully aware that He investigates before He takes action.**

How did God respond to sin in the beginning?

Genesis 4: 9-10… Again God is asking questions He already knows the answer to. God is about to pronounce a Judgement. He is about to acknowledge and finalise the decisions Cain himself had already made…**Investigation prior to action.**

Genesis 6: 5… God is personalising his involvement in the investigation prior to carrying out his sentence.

Genesis 11: 5… God came down?

Genesis 18: 17… God is stating that he will not conceal his process and rationale (investigation), before carrying out His sentence upon Sodom and Gomorrah.

Genesis 18: 20-21… What? God already knew? God operated in an open way so all could see how he is fair in his sentencing. Why is God so paranoid to establish confidence in his judgement?

Jude 1: 7… What happened in Sodom and Gomorrah is an example of what will happen in the last days. (investigation prior to judgement, in order to reveal his workings).

Satan: The accuser.

Revelation 12: 10… Satan is the accuser of the brethren and of God himself.

Genesis 3: 4-5… Satan's accusations against God: (Also see Job)

- God as a liar.
- God's word is meaningless.
- God is keeping something from us.
- To disregard God leads to happiness.
- Satan is concerned for her wellbeing.

The moment Eve took of the tree, she had internalised all of these accusations made from Satan. They became part of her nature! They became true! The issue of God's fairness and justice is essential in the battle of Good & Evil.

Ephesians 3: 10…God has manifold wisdom that he wants to reveal through the church, to principalities and powers in heavenly places.

The universal purpose in redemption includes the vindication of the name and character of God, which have been challenged by Satan and questioned by angels. This is the greatest spectacle that heavenly intelligences can contemplate (1 Cor 4: 9). What must the course of history look like to them, as from their vantage point they can observe the interplay of forces and events?

1 Peter 1: 12…Angels are intensely interested in the plan of redemption. God is convincing the universe that we are fit for heaven.

Conclusion:

Judgement is not God choosing who will be saved or lost, but rather God recognising those who have themselves chosen to be saved or lost. In the end there are two classes of people: those whom say to God, your will be done, and those to whom God says your will be done.

Revelation 22: 11…God is not coming to make any new decisions; he is coming to let them have what they want. Its our own decisions we make now we should be concerned about. In the end there are two classes of people, those who say to God, your will be done and those to whom God says your will be done.

Part two:

Three phases of judgement:

- Pre-Advent Judgement. (investigative Judgement)
- Millennial Judgement.
- Executive Judgement.

In the judgment message, the Bible really saturates the Judgement with the ministry of Jesus. For example, in a judgement scene in an earthly court we have certain participants that are necessary;

- Judge.
- Lawyer.
- Witness.

John 5: 22…According to this text, Jesus will be our Judge.

Acts 17: 31…God will judge the world through him whom was raised from the dead…Jesus.

1 John 2: 1…An advocate is simply a person who argues or defends the cause of another. In a judgement scenario this is referred to as a lawyer.

Revelation 1: 5…Here Jesus is referred to as "the faithful witness". This implies he is bound to tell the truth.

Revelation 3: 14…Again Jesus is depicted as the faithful and true witness.

Once Saved always Saved
John 10:28 – look at v27; 1 Cor 9:27; Ps 51:11 – suggests its possible for the spirit to leave.

What is being judged?

Hebrews 4: 13…There is nothing hidden from God.

Ecclesiastes 12: 13,14…Every secret thing? This includes the motives of the heart.

Important point: for judgement to take place there must be a standard by which to judge.

James 2: 10-12…James mentions that we will be judged by the law of liberty, and then quotes two of the Ten Commandments.

Galatians 2: 20…This text is commonly misapplied, and when taken out of context, is often used to support the abolishment of the Ten Commandments. In actual fact, Paul is simply eluding to the fact that righteousness comes by the life and efficacy of Jesus, rather than the works of the law.

Crucified with Christ: Paul had accepted the atonement provided by Christ's death upon the cross (Rom. 6:3–11; Phil. 3:8–10). He considered himself as dead to sin, to the world, and to man-devised methods of attaining to righteousness, as if he had actually been crucified. These methods no longer appealed to him, and in his heart there was no response to them.

It is no longer I who live: While dead to some things, Paul was very much alive to others. He was as active after conversion as he was before, for the life of a Christian is not one of inactivity. Jesus spoke of this new life as a more abundant life (John 10:10). Since Jesus is the source of life, there can be no true appreciation of life apart from Him.

Christ lives in me: This is the secret of a successful Christian life—Christ abiding within and living out in us the same perfect life that He lived here on earth. The love of Christ constrains him (2 Cor. 5:14), and the righteousness of Christ becomes a reality in his life (Rom. 8:3, 4).